TRUSTMRR DATASET · 1,000 STARTUPS · VC INVESTMENT MEMO

Building Quietly, Winning Big

What 1,000 startup profiles reveal about the real relationship between social media attention and revenue.

Prepared for Investment Committee Review

Source: TrustMRR 1,000-row dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026

THE ASSUMPTION WE'RE TESTING

“More Followers Should Mean More Customers”

It's the default heuristic in early-stage investing — a large, engaged audience looks like a distribution moat before a single dollar of revenue exists.

Visibility = Proof

A large following signals product-market resonance before the P&L does.

Cheap Acquisition

Investors assume an audience converts into a low-CAC funnel.

Founder Halo Effect

Vocal, followed founders are read as sharper operators.

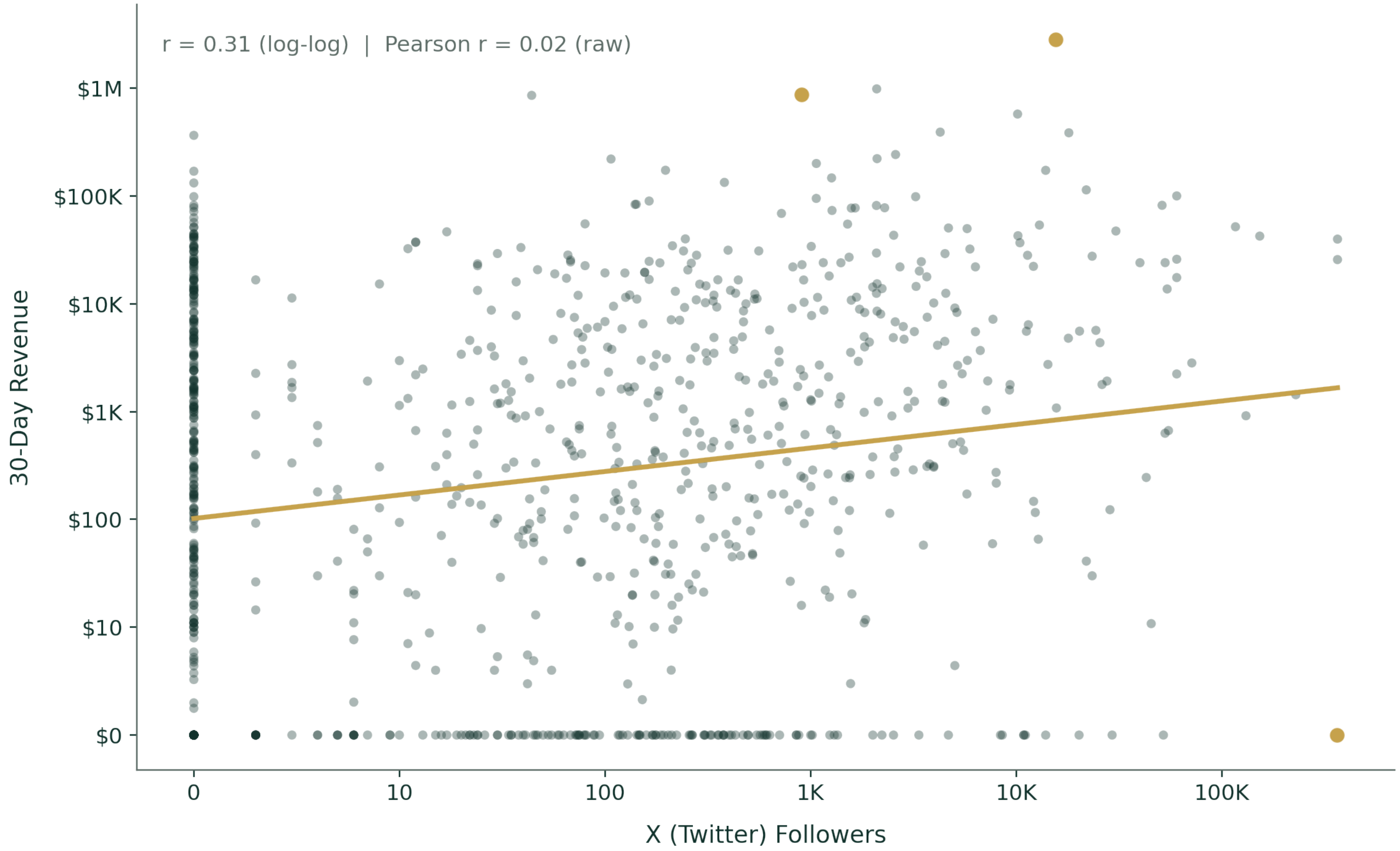
THE QUESTION

Does this actually hold across 1,000 real startup balance sheets?

We tested it against X follower counts, 30-day / 12-month / all-time revenue, MRR, MRR growth, and active subscriptions for all 1,000 profiles.

FINDING 01 — CORRELATION

Followers Explain Almost None of the Variance in Revenue



0.02

Pearson r, followers vs. 30-day revenue (raw)

0.31

Pearson r, log-log (still weak)

–0.01

Correlation with revenue growth rate

An r near zero means: knowing a startup's follower count tells you almost nothing about its revenue.

FINDING 02 — THE EXCEPTIONS

Zero Followers, $365K a Month. 365,000 Followers, $0.

QUIET OPERATORS (few followers, real revenue)

Stealth Company 0 followers	$365,047 / mo
Stealth Company 43 followers	$857,622 / mo
Stack Influence 900 followers	$868,322 / mo
BackPedal Ltd 139 followers	$83,522 / mo

LOUD, UNMONETIZED (huge audience, no revenue)

Stalkr 361,974 followers	$0 / mo
The Visual Hackademy 52,055 followers	$0 / mo
ConfettiTherapy.com 29,306 followers	$0 / mo
ScreenSnipper 20,245 followers	$0 / mo

Only 1 of the top 10 most-followed startups also ranks in the top 10 by revenue. The two leaderboards are almost entirely different companies.

FINDING 03 — THE MECHANISM

Revenue Follows Buying Committees, Not Timelines

01

Sales-Led, Not Feed-Led

The highest earners run on Stripe subscriptions sold through direct outreach, referral, and search — channels invisible on a follower count.

02

Niche Beats Broad

Products serving a narrow, high-willingness-to-pay buyer (agencies, engineers, operators) monetize a small audience far better than a viral one.

03

Enterprise Doesn't Scroll

B2B buying decisions run through procurement and referrals — the buyer researching your product is rarely the follower engaging with your posts.

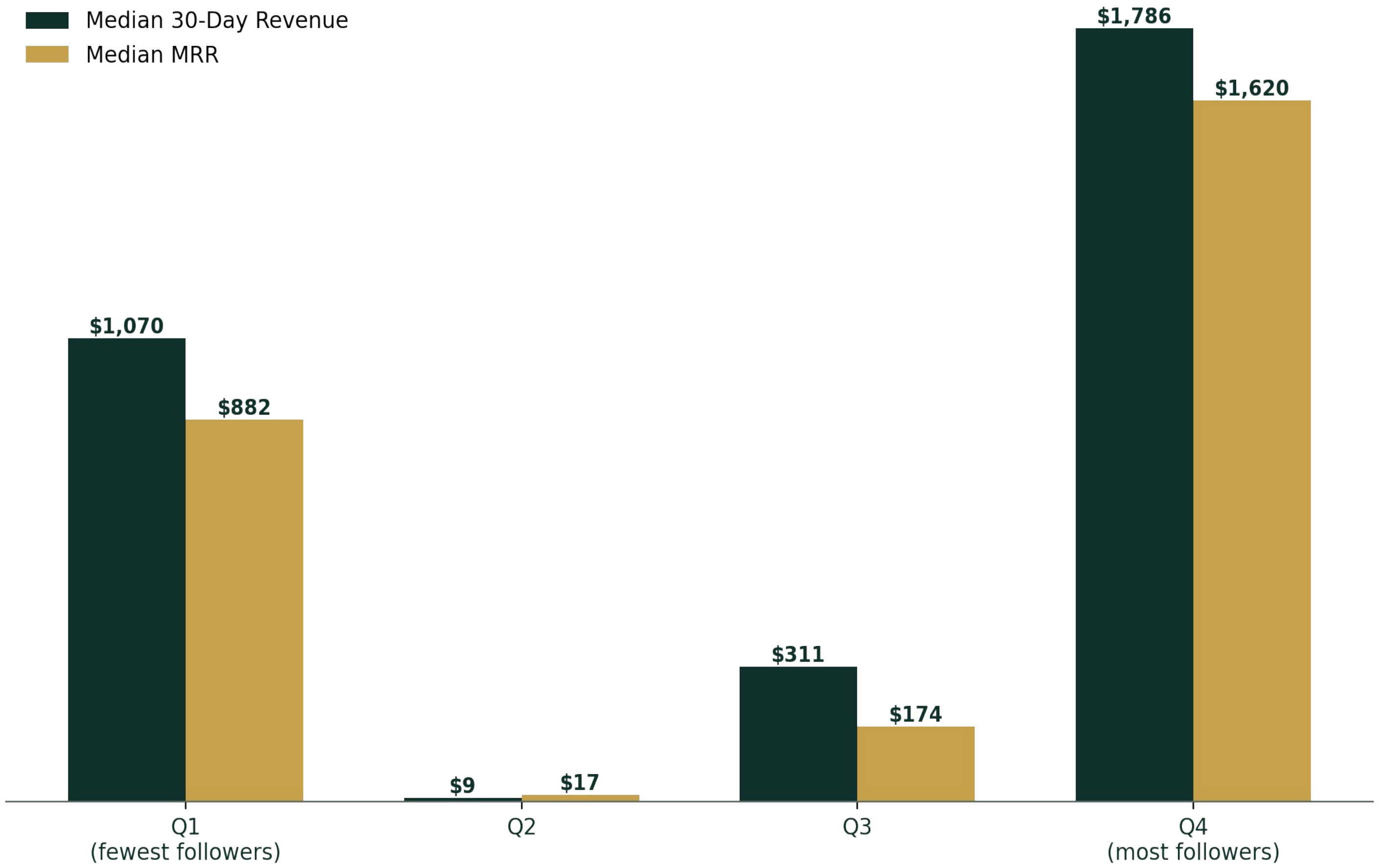
04

Virality ≠ Intent

Large follower counts often reflect meme reach or a founder's personal brand, not demand for the specific product being sold.

FINDING 04 — WHAT TO WATCH INSTEAD

Monetization Metrics Separate Winners. Follower Count Doesn't.



Median revenue & MRR by follower quartile — no clean, monotonic relationship. Q1 (fewest followers) already outperforms Q2 and Q3.

PRIORITIZE INSTEAD

- MRR & MRR growth — direct evidence of recurring, compounding demand
- Active subscriptions — retention and habitual usage, not one-time spikes
- Revenue growth rate — momentum the top line alone won't show
- Revenue multiple / asking price — how the market already prices the business

INVESTMENT THESIS

Followers measure attention. Fund monetization.

Across 1,000 startups, social reach showed a near-zero raw correlation with revenue and no relationship with growth rate. Diligence should weight MRR, growth, retention, and pricing power — not audience size.